

Is this a valid solution to the upcoming AI energy crisis?

Posted by u/dragonsowl • 0 points • 7 comments

I have read numerous posts and articles about how AI processing is using and will continue to use copious amounts of water and energy.

Most of this discourse is about how negatively it will effect the average consumer of electricity and how it is counteracting many plans we had in place for reducing our energy use and greenhouse gas emissions.

Wouldn't the best solution be to start moving the AI datafarms up to space? We need a reason to kickstart our orbital industrial base, and with the amount of investment being thrown at AI I feel like they would be the perfect customer.

We have SpaceX and the companies copying it working to lower launch costs. Solar in space is one of the most efficient and boundless means of energy production we have. Starlink has already proven proof of concept to integrate large numbers of satellites to our internet infrastructure, and most AI processing is done off-site and interfaced through the internet to the end consumer.

Finally, venting waste heat into space resolves the water requirements.

I don't know why this isn't being talked about? Is it because the technologies aren't quite there yet?

Let me know what I'm not seeing.

Comments

u/Economy-Fee5830 • 1 points • 2024-07-02 22:25 UTC

If you really wanted to interfere with the market you could mandate that data centres over x amount of compute be matched with renewable energy, which would help increase the amount of renewable

energy on the grid.

In reality I think this is the case with most cloud companies already like Azure and Google Cloud.

u/baitnnswitch • 3 points • 2024-07-02 22:24 UTC

Honestly the best solution is to limit its use. Not every single tool and platform needs some kind of AI built in. Most of it is not adding value for folks and is instead costing us jobs. Leave AI to the doctors as a diagnostic tool, researchers, etc. Basically it needs to be regulated like a finite resource - because when it uses so much water and land and precious materials, it can't just be left alone.

u/OakBaylsANecropolis • 1 points • 2024-07-02 22:27 UTC

Just price energy properly, including the emissions produced in its generation, and the market will decide what needs AI.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-07-02 22:17 UTC

[removed]

u/LeatherComparison295 • 3 points • 2024-07-02 22:14 UTC

Computers hate space. we only recently made a very basic pc that could endure space:

<https://youtu.be/1I3dKErVI8?t=8>

u/thingsorfreedom • 7 points • 2024-07-02 22:10 UTC

>Let me know what I'm not seeing.

Cost for solar per watt is now 25 cents.

Cost to put 1kg into space is \$90,000.

u/WanderingSimpleFish • 1 points • 2024-07-02 22:19 UTC

That's how it starts but that process would come down to